

for steady motion to establish his own theory: that force changes motion but is not essential to sustain it (the concept of inertia). Newton, in turn, built on this and formalized it into his first law of motion. He also adopted Aristotle's view of time as uniform and ever-flowing.

Aristotle also pioneered the scientific study of plants and animals. He was fascinated by the idea of classifying living things and used empirical investigation to develop theories about the animal world. In *The Generation of Animals*, for example, he proposed that animals develop in their mother's womb or in eggs. Around one-third of Aristotle's surviving texts are on zoology.

Like his mentor Plato, Aristotle was also committed to education. He set up the Lyceum in Athens, which became the first institute to offer a comprehensive education in all areas of knowledge, from physics to politics, drama, and poetry: similar in scope to a modern university.

“Our observations of the stars make it evident ... **that the Earth is circular.**”

Aristotle

